

The Audit-Ready Shift Note Checklist

A free one-pager from Edward at Caira — a support worker who got sick of writing notes from memory at 9pm.

This is general guidance to help you write your **own** clear, factual notes. It is not legal or compliance advice, and it does not guarantee any audit outcome. Always follow your provider's policies and the current NDIS rules.

The 5 bones of a note that holds up

- ☐ **When** — date and start/finish time of the support
- ☐ **Who** — participant and who else was present
- ☐ **Goal** — which support goal this shift was working toward
- ☐ **What happened** — what you actually did and what the participant did
- ☐ **Response** — how the participant responded / any change observed

The factual-language test

- ☐ Written in plain language a stranger could follow in two years
- ☐ States **observations**, not opinions dressed up as facts (*"declined lunch" ✓ — "was being difficult" ✗*)
- ☐ Person-first and respectful (about the person, not a label)
- ☐ Any incident recorded calmly: what / when / who / what you did / who you told
- ☐ No guesses at cause written as if confirmed

The habit that makes it painless

- ☐ **Captured in the moment**, not reconstructed at home (voice memo, notes app, or paper — then tidy later)
- ☐ Written, checked and saved **same day**
- ☐ Stored consistently — one place per participant, same structure each time

Quick self-check: If someone read this note in two years with zero context, would they understand what happened, why, and how the participant responded? If yes — you're done. If no — add the missing bone above.

Caira is the tool I'm building to make this automatic — capture a note in the moment and keep the bones above by default, so the time goes back to care. It's pre-launch; if you'd like to help shape it and be first in line, just reach out.

Care is the work. Caira handles the record. · caira.net.au